

KICKOFF PROMPT: NEXT CLAUDE CODE SESSION (after 2026-09-01)

Written 2026-09-01, EXTENDED 2026-09-02 morning after the slice was brought up and Stephen began playing chapter 1. Paste everything below the line into a fresh session in this repo. Memory (*project_state.md*) is current and is the authority where this prompt is stale.

★ 2026-09-02 UPDATE, READ THIS FIRST: THE SLICE PLAYS, AND YOUR FIRST JOB IS BUGS

Stephen is playing chapter 1 of *The Friends with Four Keys* in the editor (Main Merge, menu **AQ** → **Four Keys Slice** → **Enabled**, then QA Reset + Play). It works now, and **he has reported "a few issues" to fix**: getting the playtest bug list and fixing them is your first task, ahead of everything below. Ask him for the specific issues, reproduce, fix, and verify.

Two bugs were already found and fixed this morning (context for the ones that remain):

1. The toggle lived in `PlayerPrefs`, which QA Reset wipes (`PlayerPrefs.DeleteAll`), so every "QA Reset + Play" silently reverted to The Listener. Moved to `EditorPrefs` (commit 508ea66).
2. The slice swapped the leads database at `AfterSceneLoad`, but the caseflow orchestrator bound the ep01 catalog's Listener database a few frames later and clobbered it, and the FTUE choreographer then played Dot's voicemail on top. Fixed with a slice driver that re-applies the slice DB until it sticks (polling `LeadsRepository` only, no cross-assembly board refs) and a gate that no-ops the FTUE choreographer under the slice flag (commit 38doc96).

The architectural honesty you inherit: the slice piggybacks on the Listener scene (swaps the DB, installs the package runtime, suppresses the Listener intro). That was the fast route to a playable test, and it carries fragility (the bind race above was one instance). If the remaining bugs trace to the same root (Listener boot machinery running under the slice), the clean fix is a proper slice entry (its own episode slot or a dedicated scene) rather than more suppression patches; weigh that with Stephen before piling on more gates. **Boot flow is a documented fragile area (CLAUDE.md); change it carefully and headless-test.**

Slice files (all on main): `Assets/App/Leads/Packages/` (`PackageData`, `PackageCatalog`, `PackageProgressService`, `PackageRuntimeMB`, `FourKeysSliceBootstrap` + `FourKeysSliceDriverMB`), `Assets/App/UI/Packages/PackageBeatPresenterMB.cs`, `Assets/Editor/FourKeysSliceMenu.cs`, content under `Assets/Content/FourKeys/` and `Assets/Resources/App/FourKeys/`, tests `Assets/Tests/EditMode/PackageProgressServiceTests.cs`. Headless test recipe needs the editor CLOSED; when Stephen has it open, either wait or reason from the console via the mcp-unity bridge (`get_console_logs`) which IS available live.

The original agenda (still valid after the bugs are cleared)

You are picking up AQ30 (Ally Quinn: True Crime Merge) the morning after a landmark day. Read `MEMORY.md` and the Four Keys block of `project_state.md` first; they are current. Then read this agenda. Stephen's rulings in memory are never reopened.

Where everything stands (one paragraph each)

Story. Episode 1 is *The Friends with Four Keys*. The chain is complete and attack-hardened: premise v8.1 · spine v1.4 (three GPT rounds; the sweep passes on Margo's six-week silence, the episode's one named character lock) · cold open v0.4 (reader-checked, voice-research register) · economy model v1.1 (ruled: 1,600 T1eq, ~100 packages, no optionals) · structure v2.2 (100 played / 105 authored packages across 10 chapters; GPT five-front attack and the overnight critical review both folded; D3 forks chapter 7 and D4 forks the close, so the agency gate passes; Part F is fully ruled, including the season notch: the deckhand's photographs and Gerald's ask). The full-graph synopsis is `SAS/four-keys-episode-synopsis-v1.0.md`: orientation for you, **never** for Fable, readers, testers or marketing. Chapter 1's prose exists as DRAFT (`SAS/four-keys-prose/ch01.md`, briefs beside drafts, digest at `story-so-far.md`), unruled by design: Stephen chose to play before ruling lines.

Code. Everything is merged to main (at 59e3bda tonight): the multi-episode system (play-verified; slot ep01 plays The Listener; HUD selector entry still owed a scene pass), the lead-package spine (`Assets/App/Leads/Packages/`: `PackageData`, `PackageCatalog+Validate`, `PackageProgressService` with the rule-5/rule-6 discipline, `PackageRuntimeMB`, `PackageBeatPresenterMB`, 13 `EditMode` tests), and the **chapter 1 vertical slice**: 12 cards, 10 packages, 10 beat `CaseGraphs` (v0.4 verbatim plus the Del steps scene; every node's `voiceClip` slot wired and empty per Stephen's text-first-but-VO-ready ruling), slice DB and catalog under `Resources/App/FourKeys/`, and a dev toggle (menu **AQ** → **Four Keys Slice** → **Enabled**, pref `aq.dev.fk_slice`, bootstrap swaps the database and installs the runtime at `AfterSceneLoad`; off = The Listener untouched). Headless `EditMode` baseline: 141/150, the 8 failures are the documented legacy scene-dependent set.

The playable moment. Stephen can now play chapter 1: pull main, open `Assets/Scenes/Main Merge.unity`, tick the AQ menu toggle, press Play. This is the project's rank-one experiment: does merging change what a player believes; does a beat every couple of minutes pay or interrupt; does the accusation landing on package 4's completion feel earned; does board-first Del land. Slice edges, known and deliberate: text advances on tap, no beat art, Del name-only portrait, the OPEN working-note lines deferred, the Listener caseflow idling harmlessly underneath.

The agenda, in order

1. **Collect Stephen's playtest verdict** (feel, seams, lines, bugs) and dispose of it the house way: record verbatim in SAS with a disposition table, fix what is mechanical, put rulings to him one at a time with full explanation (he prefers being asked one by one), fold F4's seam re-ruling in the editor if the cut needs re-seaming (words never change without him).
2. **Chapter 1 line rulings in context**, against `SAS/four-keys-prose/ch01.md` (the file shows each brief beside its draft; the three weakest lines are already named in its header). Fold rulings into the file and the digest.
3. **Chapter 2 prose**: re-run `SAS/prompt-claude-fable-briefs-four-keys-kickoff.md`: it is re-runnable by design (resumes from the first missing chapter file) and its blindness discipline is the whole game: Fable subagents get ONLY the standing base plus the digest; you leak-check briefs before and prose after against the spine; chapter 10 last, close last. The previous session's orchestrator agent is gone with that session; the files are the state.

4. **Build queue, after the playtest verdict shapes it:** bar grouping (needed from chapter 4's three-carders), FTUE seam polish per the verdict, the HUD selector scene pass, beat-art placeholder pipeline, per-package analytics. The costing doc (`SAS/feature-lead-packages-v1.md`) prices it; two of its rulings remain (member-card toasts, MVP cut).
5. **Standing items, not yours to forget:** the tester question (cold open v0.4 to the twelve: Stephen's call, the critical reviewer's open objection) · the allergy clinic (~Sep 9) then the submit-window ruling · the two season follow-ons that must precede Ep2's spine: rebase the §3.3 ladder off The Listener, and decide what the deckhand's photograph holds.

House discipline (the expensive lessons, compressed)

- **Ask Stephen rulings one at a time, with the full context and what-breaks-otherwise stated; options with a recommendation first.** He rejects batches and forms without context.
- **Reader verdicts outrank craft:** plain over crafted; a notch is an action, not a reaction; protect-list lines are not immune (all in `feedback_story_craft.md`).
- **Fable stays blind to spine Parts A to F** until the close briefs. Attack results are saved verbatim with disposition tables; a document only counts as attacked when a result file exists.
- **Check the code before trusting any spec** (`feedback_check_implementation_first.md`). The robustness rules in `CLAUDE.md` are load-bearing; the package code shows the pattern (state-scan, seen-after-display, paid-idempotence).
- **No em dashes anywhere, in any file.** Markdown renders to html/pdf via `SAS/tools/Convert-MdToPdf.ps1` (PowerShell + headless Chrome; Python 3.12 also exists). ⚠ The Bash tool here chokes on long heredocs: write files with the Write tool and run them.
- **Headless tests:** `Unity.exe -batchmode -nographics -projectPath <path> -runTests -testPlatform EditMode` (editor must be closed for the same project; a git worktree gives you an independent project at the cost of a first import). Code work while Stephen's editor is open goes in a worktree; never switch his checked-out branch without the editor closed and his word.
- **Commit as you go, push at day end, update project_state.md at every landing.** The daily nag and the critical reviewer cloud routines are current as of tonight; refresh their prompts when the queue shifts materially.

First move (updated 2026-09-02)

Say good morning, `git pull` (main is at 38doc96 or later), then **ask Stephen for the chapter 1 playtest bug list and fix it** before anything else. The mcp-unity bridge is live while his editor is open: use `get_console_logs` (`includeStackTrace false`) to see what the running game is doing. Only once the slice plays cleanly do you move to the playtest *design* verdict (feel, turns, Del, lines) and the agenda above.